

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Lightning

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

When you hear thunder, move into a substantial building or enclosed hard-top vehicle immediately. There is no safe place outdoors during a thunderstorm. Wait at least 30 minutes after the last thunder before going back out.

Do now.

☐**Leave exposed areas**

01

Get out of water and off ridges, fields and beaches. Do not shelter beneath a lone tree.

☐**Choose real shelter**

02

Use a building or enclosed hard-top vehicle; picnic shelters and tents are not adequate.

☐**Avoid indoor pathways**

03

Stay away from showers, sinks, corded phones and plugged-in equipment.

☐**Help a struck person**

04

Call emergency services. A lightning victim carries no electrical charge; give CPR if needed and follow dispatcher instructions.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Choose a substantial building or enclosed hard-top vehicle now. A tent, tree or open-sided shelter is not protective. If no shelter is available, reduce exposure while moving toward one; there is no outdoor posture that makes lightning safe.

Watch for.

Lightning can strike beyond rainfall. Do not wait for rain to seek shelter.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area

Next decision.

Check forecasts before outdoor activity and identify shelter before leaving it.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Lightning · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/lightning/>